content with just paying homage to Bhagat Singh. What he and his followers have been demanding for some years now, consistent with a claim raised a year earlier, is that Bhagat Singh be given the accolade of 'Nishan-e-Haider',[7] so that he is declared a 'national' martyr by the Pakistan government; that it issue a postage stamp in his name; that it put up a statue at Shadman Chowk which should be re-named as 'Bhagat Singh Chowk' and that there be an apology from the British queen for the hanging of Bhagat Singh and his comrades.[8]

Thus it is that, almost a hundred years after the death of Bhagat Singh, two groups in Pakistan now want him declared a 'national hero'. These are the Bhagat Singh Memorial Foundation (BSMF) and the Bhagat Singh Foundation Pakistan (BSFP). On the eighty-seventh death anniversary of the freedom fighter on 23 March 2018, each group held separate functions at Shadman Chowk, where Bhagat Singh and his two comrades were allegedly hanged, under strict security arrangements. Each had participants pay glowing tributes to those they considered martyred by the state, as they had done in years past. In fact, there was even a telephone address from some relatives of Bhagat Singh from across the border in India that was arranged by the organizers, such was their desire to rise above communal interests and support the cause of a non-sectarian, pluralistic and egalitarian society, which they believed had been denied them as their birthright ever since they gained Independence. The leaders of both organizations spoke similarly. Imtiaz Rashid, the chairman of BSMF, 'presented a resolution demanding the British Queen to tender an apology for hanging the three freedom fighters and compensate their families'. He also demanded naming a road after Bhagat Singh and revising the Pakistani school curriculum to include a chapter on Bhagat Singh. For his part, Abdullah Malik, the president of BSFP, reminded the audience of how 'Bhagat Singh raised his voice against imperialism' and that it was high time that the governments of both India and of Pakistan declare Bhagat Singh and his comrades 'national heroes'.

All this despite the fact that these proposals are strenuously opposed by the Hurmat-e-Rasool, a sister organization of Jamaat-u-Dawah, led by the